

Meridian Freight & Logistics — Leave Policy

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1. Scope

This policy applies to all depot-based and head-office employees of Meridian Freight & Logistics, across all regional locations. It supersedes MFL-HR-POL-03 (Version 3.x) in full.

2. Annual Leave Entitlement

Full-time employees accrue 20 days of annual leave per calendar year, credited at 1.67 days per completed month of service. Part-time depot staff accrue leave on a pro-rata basis calculated against their contracted weekly hours.

3. Sick Leave

Employees are entitled to 12 sick leave days per calendar year. Sick leave exceeding 2 consecutive days requires a medical certificate submitted within 3 working days of return. Effective this version (4.0), depot supervisors may no longer approve sick leave extensions themselves — all extensions beyond 5 consecutive days now require HR Business Partner sign-off, a change from the prior policy version.

4. Emergency and Compassionate Leave

Up to 5 days of paid compassionate leave are available per qualifying event (immediate family bereavement or medical emergency), approved directly by the depot manager without HR pre-approval, provided it is logged in the HR system within 48 hours.

5. How to Apply

All planned leave must be submitted through the HR Self-Service Portal at least 5 working days in advance. Depot managers approve requests within 2 working days. Unplanned/emergency leave should be phoned in to the depot manager directly, with the portal entry completed within 24 hours.

6. Revision History

Version 4.0 (1 July 2026): Sick leave extension approval moved from depot supervisor to HR Business Partner. Version 3.2 (1 January 2026): Annual leave accrual rate clarified for part-time staff. Version 3.0 (1 March 2025): Initial consolidated policy release, replacing regional variations.